

How to Use Plan Console Without an API Key

The API key is optional. Plan Console works seamlessly with your AI coding agent via copy-paste—completely free, with zero model queues.

How It Works

The console and your agent never talk to each other directly. Instead, communication happens securely through clipboard actions and repository files:

Console → **Agent** : ready-made instructions (copied to clipboard, popup, or saved in plans/<slug>/instructions/)

Agent → **Console** : files generated in your repo (plans/<slug>/...)

The console always checks the files afterward, ensuring half-finished or lazy agent work still gets caught.

Step by Step

1 Intake

Paste your brainstorm or audit report into the **Intake** tab. Pick the type, type a slug, and click **Proceed**. Copy the instruction from the popup and paste it into your agent with the repo open as the workspace

folder. The agent will create the draft plan, open questions, and the recon checklist.

2 Owner Pass

Answer the questions in [OPEN-QUESTIONS.md](#) (delete each answered line), run any owner-only commands yourself, and tick [\[x\]](#) the finished items in [RECON-CHECKLIST.md](#).

3 Recon (Optional)

Click "**Run recon**" and paste the popup instruction into your agent. It checks your repo locally—instant and free.

4 Validate

Click "**Validate draft**" and paste the instruction. The agent writes the report to [plans/<slug>/VALIDATION.md](#). Click "**Show validation report**" in the console to read it with a verdict.

5 Freeze

Click **Freeze**. This step is instant and involves no agent. By design, the console will refuse to freeze while questions or checklist items remain unresolved.

6 Sessions

Go to the **Sessions tab**. Enter your slug + session number, click "**Copy session instruction**", and paste it into your agent to watch it work. Click "**Session report**" for the verdict before moving to the next session. The console blocks skipping ahead (e.g., session 3 cannot run before 1 and 2 are complete).

7 Deploy

The final session is owner-supervised. Click "**Plan health**" first for the pre-deploy check.